altitude warfare equipment.[17] Pakistan-backed forces exploited this weakness, forcing an Indian retreat. Not until the spring of 1948 did the Indian forces managed to launch a counteroffensive. The Indian counteroffensive and its attendant territorial gains, however, resulted in more direct involvement by the Pakistan Army in Kashmir. And this, in turn, created further problems for the Indians. Pakistan Army parachute and artillery unit deployments, for example, threatened the slender communication links between Amritsar and the cities of Jammu, Pathankot, and Poonch in the state of Kashmir.[18]

As the fighting continued in this back-and-forth manner, Indian leaders concluded that the conflict would continue indefinitely unless they could devise a strategy to end Pakistani support for the Kashmiri rebels. To accomplish this end, India would have to dramatically expand the scope of the conflict. But the Indians realized they lacked the military resources to carry out such a strategy.[19] Cognizant of their military limitations, and acting on the advice of Lord Mountbatten, India referred the Kashmir question to the United Nations Security Council on January 1, 1948, where a diplomatic battle ensued.[20] On January 1, 1949, the UN imposed a cease-fire. At the time of the cease-fire, Pakistan was in possession of about one-third of the princely state and India the remaining two-thirds.

A second Indo-Pakistani war for Kashmir erupted sixteen years later. Its outbreak bore a striking similarity to the first Kashmir conflict. Pakistan again sought to seize the territory, using soldiers disguised as local inhabitants. A confluence of events—including internal political disturbances in Indian-controlled Kashmir in December 1963, the death of Prime Minister Nehru in 1964, the presence of a new and untested prime minister, Lal Bahadur Shastri, at the national helm, and India's willingness to refer a border dispute along the state of Gujarat to the International Court of Justice in May 1965—led the Pakistani military dictatorship of Ayub Khan to conclude that India would be unable to withstand a swift Pakistani onslaught. Based on this assumption, the Pakistanis forged a military strategy designed to seize the Indian-controlled portion of Kashmir. The plan had two distinct segments. The first was Operation Gibraltar and the second Operation Grand Slam. The initial segment